Day 74 - Beth Gilhespy, John Appleton, Mshkiki Miikaansing, Hawthorn

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 95 · Barrow Bay

10.5 km / 6.5 mi	~3.8 h	5.6 km new	200 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

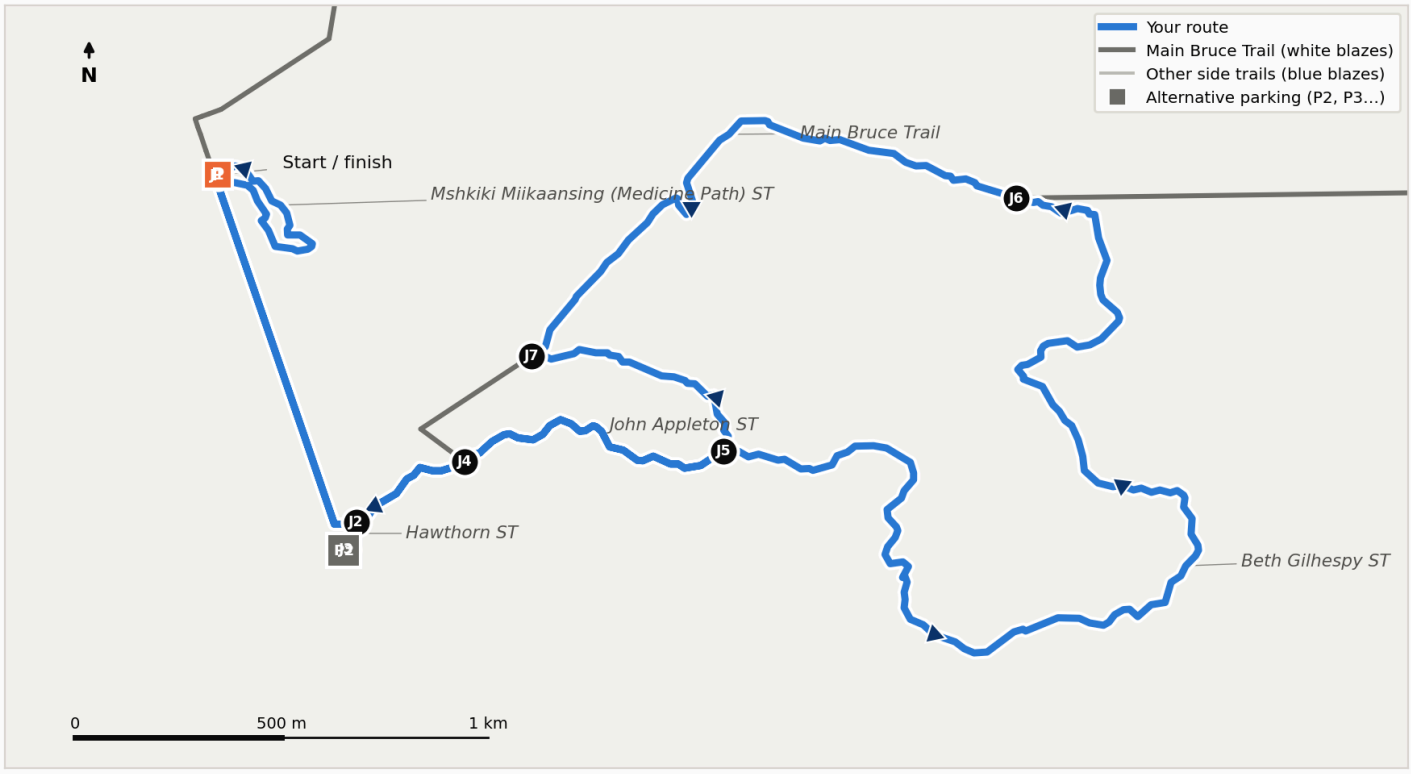
Park (P): Bruce Trail Parking Lot: Off of Bruce Rd 9 in Barrow Bay, just south of West Shore Rd. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day74_hike095.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Beth Gilhespy Side Trail (3.4 km); John Appleton Side Trail (1.4 km); Mshkiki Miikaansing (Medicine Path) Side Trail (0.7 km); Hawthorn Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map

Day 74 | 10.5 km (6.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Use the Bruce Trail lot off Bruce Rd 9 in Barrow Bay. The local club asks hikers not to park on the west side of Bruce Rd 9.
- **Barrow Bay Cliffs:** The main trail south of Barrow Bay runs through the Bruce Trail Conservancy's Barrow Bay Cliffs Nature Reserve (bought in 2019), a newer section that passes cliffs, lookouts and dense forest, with a staircase from the escarpment edge down to the shoreline. Keep Zappy close near the cliff edges.
- **John Appleton & Beth Gilhespy Side Trails:** The John Appleton loop passes a beaver pond and winds through hardwood forest and fractured dolostone rock on a natural, moderate surface. Watch your footing (and paws) on the cracked rock.
- **Medicine Path & Hawthorn Side Trails:** Short connectors (0.7 km and 0.1 km). No specific trail descriptions were found.
- **Road walking:** Parts of the main trail follow the shoulder of Bruce Rd 9 near Barrow Bay, at the start and end of the day. Keep Zappy on a short leash and on the outside, away from traffic.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	BTC Parking Area on the east side of the road; emergency #2461 Bruce County Rd 9 map	Free	1.8	0 m	Hawthorn, John Appleton

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 4.9 km / 3.1 mi, covering Hawthorn, John Appleton, Mshkiki Miikaansing (Medicine Path). **Outing 2** from P2 (BTC Parking Area on the east side of the road;

> emergency #2461 Bruce County Rd 9; Free): 7.5 km / 4.6 mi, covering Beth Gilhespy, John Appleton. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Bruce Trail Parking Lot: Off of Bruce Rd 9 in Barrow Bay, just south of West Shore Rd. Head south-east on the blue-blazed Mshkiki Miikaansing (Medicine Path) Side Trail.
0.7	0.4	J1: You pass the start again. Keep going on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south.
1.7	1.0	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Hawthorn Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.7	1.1	J3: End of the Hawthorn Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (BTC Parking Area on the east side of the road; emergency #2461 Bruce County Rd 9). Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.8	1.1	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
2.1	1.3	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed John Appleton Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.9	1.8	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Beth Gilhespy Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed John Appleton Side Trail goes off on your left.)
6.2	3.9	J6: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
7.8	4.9	J7: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed John Appleton Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
8.4	5.3	J5: Junction. Turn right to stay on the John Appleton Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Beth Gilhespy Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
9.2	5.7	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
9.5	5.9	J2: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the Hawthorn Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
9.6	5.9	Heads-up: The next 0.9 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
10.5	6.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Bruce Peninsula Press and Ontario Nature Trails.